

THE CIVILIAN REBUILD BLUEPRINT

Mid-Course Project — Assigned After Module 5

PROJECT OVERVIEW

You are at the halfway point. You've covered identity, structure, finances, career, and resilience. Now it's time to stop absorbing and start building.

This is not a quiz. This is not busywork. This is your actual life plan — the document you should be able to hand to someone and say, "This is who I am, where I'm going, and how I'm getting there."

The Civilian Rebuild Blueprint combines everything from Modules 1 through 5 into one complete, working document. By the time you finish it, you'll have a clearer picture of your civilian life than most people get after years of stumbling around. That clarity is earned — not given.

Do this right. Future you is counting on it.

ESTIMATED COMPLETION TIME

6 to 10 hours across multiple sessions. Do not try to crank this out in one sitting. Some sections require honest reflection that takes time. Block it into your schedule like a mission brief — specific times, no distractions.

Suggested breakdown:

- Session 1 (90 min): Part 1 — Identity Map
 - Session 2 (90 min): Part 2 — Daily Structure
 - Session 3 (90 min): Part 3 — Financial Snapshot
 - Session 4 (90 min): Part 4 — Career Transition Plan
 - Session 5 (90 min): Part 5 — Resilience System
 - Session 6 (60 min): Reflection + review + polish
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INSTRUCTIONS

Complete all five parts in order. Each part builds on the last. Write in complete sentences unless instructed otherwise. Be specific — vague answers like "get a good job" or "do better financially" will not pass. Honest, specific, and actionable is the standard.

You may type your responses directly into this document template or into a clean Word/Google Doc. Format it clearly. Label every section.

Submit your completed Blueprint through the course portal under **Module 5 Submissions** by the stated deadline.

PART 1: IDENTITY MAP

Module Reference: Module 1 — Who You Are Now

Your identity is the foundation. If this part is shaky, everything built on top of it will wobble. Take your time here.

1A. Who You Were Before the Military

Answer the following in 1-3 paragraphs:

- How old were you when you enlisted or commissioned? What was your life like at that point?
- What did you want? What were you running toward — or away from?
- What kind of person were you? What did you care about?
- What skills, habits, or traits did you bring with you into service?

Prompt: Don't sanitize this. If you joined to get out of a bad situation, say so. If you had no plan and the recruiter caught you at the right moment, say so. Honesty here sets the tone for everything else.

1B. Who You Became in the Military

Answer the following in 1-3 paragraphs:

- What did the military make you better at?
- How did your identity change? What values, behaviors, or beliefs did you adopt?

- What roles did you hold? What were you known for among your peers?
- What are you most proud of from your service?
- What habits, mindsets, or patterns did the military give you that now cause friction in civilian life?

Prompt: Both sides of this matter. The military built real strengths into you — and also may have installed some defaults that don't serve you anymore. Name both.

1C. Who You Are Choosing to Be Now

Answer the following in 1-3 paragraphs:

- Given everything above, who are you choosing to be as a civilian?
- What parts of your military identity do you keep? What do you leave behind?
- What new characteristics are you consciously building?
- How do you want people to describe you in five years?

This is not about erasing your service. It's about deciding what goes with you and what stays at the gate.

1D. Core Values (Minimum 5)

List at least five core values. For each one:

- **State the value** (one to three words)
- **Define it in your own words** (2-4 sentences — what it means to *you*, not the dictionary definition)
- **Give one specific example** of how you live this value or intend to

Format:

VALUE: [Name]

DEFINITION: [Your personal definition]

EXAMPLE: [Specific behavioral example]

Important: Do not list values you think sound good. List the ones that actually drive your decisions — even if they're uncomfortable to admit. Authenticity > optics.

1E. Civilian Identity Statement

Write a single, powerful paragraph (5-8 sentences) that answers: *Who are you right now, as a civilian?*

This statement should:

- Be written in first person
- Reference your service without being defined entirely by it
- Name your values
- Describe what you're building
- Sound like *you* — not a LinkedIn bio, not a performance review

You will refine this statement in the Final Project. For now, make it real.

PART 2: DAILY STRUCTURE

Module Reference: Module 2 — Building Your Operating System

Discipline creates freedom. But generic discipline doesn't work. Your operating system has to be built for you — your responsibilities, your energy patterns, your goals, your life.

2A. Your Personal Operating System

Map out your ideal daily structure across three blocks:

Morning Routine

- What time do you wake up?
- What are the first three things you do after waking?
- How long is your morning routine (start to work-ready)?
- What does it include? (Physical training, journaling, reading, cold exposure, prayer, meal prep — whatever applies to you)
- What is the purpose of your morning routine — what does it do for your mental and physical state?

Work Blocks

- When are your peak focus hours?
- How many focused work blocks do you have in a day?
- How long is each block?
- How do you protect them from interruption?
- What happens between blocks? (Rest, movement, food, admin tasks)

Evening Routine

- What time do you start winding down?
- What does your evening include?
- What time do you aim to be in bed?
- What is the purpose of your evening routine?

If your current reality doesn't match your ideal, write both. Note the gap and what's causing it.

2B. Weekly Schedule Template

Build a realistic weekly schedule. Use the format below or recreate it in a table. Every major block of time should be accounted for.

MONDAY

0500-0600: [Activity]

0600-0800: [Activity]

0800-1200: [Activity]

1200-1300: [Activity]

1300-1700: [Activity]

1700-1900: [Activity]

1900-2100: [Activity]

2100+: [Wind-down / Sleep]

[Repeat for Tuesday through Sunday]

Include:

- Work/job search/school hours
- Physical training
- Family/relationship time
- Learning blocks (course, reading, certifications)
- Admin time (finances, VA appointments, household)
- Recovery/downtime
- Flex time

Your schedule doesn't have to be perfect. It has to be honest and functional. Build from where you actually are.

2C. Non-Negotiables

List 3 to 7 non-negotiable habits — things that happen every day regardless of mood, weather, motivation, or how bad yesterday was.

For each one:

- **Name the habit**
- **Frequency** (daily, 5x/week, etc.)
- **Why it's non-negotiable** (what does missing it cost you?)
- **Current status:** Locked in / Building / Inconsistent

Format:

HABIT: [Name]

FREQUENCY: [How often]

WHY: [What missing it costs you]

STATUS: [Locked In / Building / Inconsistent]

2D. Accountability System

Answer the following:

- Who or what holds you accountable? (Person, app, system, group — be specific)
 - How do you track your habits and commitments? (Journal, app, spreadsheet, whiteboard)
 - What happens when you miss a non-negotiable? What's your recovery protocol?
 - What's the single biggest threat to your structure right now? How are you countering it?
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PART 3: FINANCIAL SNAPSHOT

Module Reference: Module 3 — Building Wealth from Zero

You cannot build toward a financial goal you haven't looked at clearly. This section requires real numbers. It may be uncomfortable. Do it anyway.

Note on Privacy: This document is for your personal use and submitted confidentially. If you are not comfortable with exact figures, use ranges. But be specific enough that your snapshot is actually useful.

3A. Current Income Sources

List every source of income you currently have. For each:

- Source name (job, VA disability, spouse income, side business, rental, GI Bill BAH, etc.)
- Monthly amount (exact or estimated range)
- Stability: Stable / Variable / Ending soon

Total current monthly income: \$ _____

3B. Monthly Expenses (Categorized)

Break down your monthly expenses by category. Be thorough — forgotten expenses are the enemy of a real budget.

| Category | Monthly Amount |

|---|---|

| Housing (rent/mortgage) | \$ |

| Utilities (electric, gas, water, internet) | \$ |

| Groceries | \$ |

| Dining out / food delivery | \$ |

| Transportation (car payment, gas, insurance, maintenance) | \$ |

| Health insurance / medical out-of-pocket | \$ |

| Subscriptions (streaming, gym, software, etc.) | \$ |

| Clothing | \$ |

| Childcare / education | \$ |

| Debt payments (list separately below) | \$ |

| Entertainment / recreation | \$ |

| Personal care | \$ |

| Savings / investments | \$ |

| Other | \$ |

| **TOTAL** | \$ |

Monthly surplus or deficit: \$_____ (Income minus Expenses)

3C. Current Debt

List all debts. For each:

| Debt | Balance Owed | Interest Rate | Minimum Payment | Payoff Priority |

|---|---|---|---|---|

|||||

Total debt: \$_____

Assign a payoff priority to each (High / Medium / Low) based on interest rate and urgency. Credit cards before student loans, generally.

3D. Net Worth Estimate

Assets minus liabilities = net worth.

Assets:

- Cash/checking/savings: \$
- Retirement accounts (TSP, IRA, 401k): \$
- Vehicle value: \$
- Property value (if applicable): \$
- Other assets: \$
- **Total Assets:** \$_____

Liabilities:

- All debts (from 3C): \$
- **Total Liabilities:** \$_____

Estimated Net Worth: \$_____

If this number is negative, that's okay. A lot of veterans exit service in the hole. Knowing the number is the first step to changing it.

3E. VA Benefits: Current vs. Eligible

| Benefit | Currently Receiving? | Amount/Status | Action Needed |

|---|---|---|---|

| VA Disability Compensation | | | |

| GI Bill (specify chapter) | | | |

| Vocational Rehabilitation (Ch. 31) | | | |

| VA Home Loan COE | | | |

| VA Healthcare enrollment | | | |

| SGLI / VGLI life insurance | | | |

| Survivor Benefit Plan | | | |

| State veteran benefits | | | |

| Other | | | |

List any benefits you believe you may be eligible for but haven't applied for yet, and what's stopping you:

3F. 6-Month Financial Goal

Write one specific, measurable financial goal for the next six months. It must include:

- The target (specific dollar amount or action)
- The deadline
- The method (exactly how you will achieve it)
- What you will sacrifice or change to hit it

Example: "By November 30, I will eliminate my \$3,200 Capital One credit card debt by putting an additional \$400/month from reduced dining and entertainment spending toward the balance."

PART 4: CAREER TRANSITION PLAN

Module Reference: Module 4 — Navigating the Civilian Job Market

The military gave you a title, a rank, and a unit. The civilian world doesn't care about those things — it cares what you can produce. Your job in this section is to translate.

4A. Target Industry and Role

- **Target industry:** (e.g., cybersecurity, logistics, healthcare administration, construction management)
- **Why this industry:** (2-4 sentences — what draws you to it, what experience connects you to it)
- **Three specific job titles you are targeting:**

1.
2.
3.

- **Geographic target or remote preference:**
- **Timeline:** When do you need or want to be employed/advanced in this field?

4B. Skills Inventory

Translate your military experience into civilian language. Complete the following for at least 8 military skills or experiences:

| Military Skill / Role | Civilian Translation | Evidence / Example |

|---|---|---|

|||

Example:

| Maintained and operated SINCGARS radio systems | Communications systems maintenance; troubleshooting electronic hardware | Maintained operational readiness of 12 radio systems across 3 platoons during 9-month deployment |

Also list any civilian-applicable skills you've developed outside of your MOS/rate (languages, software, certifications, leadership training, etc.):

4C. Resume Status and Next Steps

Assess where your resume currently stands:

- **Current status:** (No resume / Draft exists / Updated / Polished and tailored)
- **Format:** (Chronological / Functional / Combination)

- **What's working:** (1-3 things)
- **What needs work:** (1-3 things)
- **Next three specific actions to improve it:**

1.
2.
3.

- **Target date for a complete, job-ready resume:**

4D. Networking Targets

Identify five specific people or organizations to connect with in your target field. For each:

| Target | Who They Are | Why Them | Connection Method | Status |

|---|---|---|---|---|

| 1. | | | | |

| 2. | | | | |

| 3. | | | | |

| 4. | | | | |

| 5. | | | | |

Specific means specific. Not "a recruiter at a defense company." A name, a company, a LinkedIn profile, a veterans networking group with a specific meeting you're attending.

Also answer: What is your biggest fear or block around networking, and what is your plan to push through it?

4E. 90-Day Action Plan

Break your next 90 days into three phases. Each phase should have 3-5 concrete actions.

Days 1-30: Foundation

- []
- []
- []
- []

- []

Days 31-60: Momentum

- []
- []
- []
- []
- []

Days 61-90: Execution

- []
- []
- []
- []
- []

Each action item must be:

- Specific (what exactly will you do)
- Measurable (how will you know it's done)
- Time-bound (by when)

PART 5: RESILIENCE SYSTEM

Module Reference: Module 5 — Mental Fitness and Resilience

This section is not about being tough. It's about being honest. The veterans who crash are usually the ones who never looked at this section carefully.

5A. Current Stress Indicators

Rate your current stress level in each area (1 = minimal, 5 = significant):

Area	Rating (1-5)	Notes
Financial pressure		
Career uncertainty		

|---|---|---|

| Financial pressure | | |

| Career uncertainty | | |

| Relationship strain | | |

| Physical health | | |

| Mental/emotional state | | |

| Housing stability | | |

| Social isolation | | |

| Purpose/direction | | |

| Sleep quality | | |

| Overall | | |

Describe your top two stressors in 2-4 sentences each. What's specifically driving them? What have you tried?

5B. Coping Patterns

List your current coping patterns — healthy and unhealthy. Be honest.

Healthy Coping Patterns I use:

(Examples: exercise, journaling, calling a friend, prayer, structured routine)

| Pattern | How Often | Effectiveness (1-5) |

|---|---|---|

| | | |

Unhealthy Coping Patterns I've noticed in myself:

(Examples: isolation, alcohol, overworking, avoiding conflict, doomscrolling, numbing out)

| Pattern | How Often | Trigger | What I'm doing about it |

|---|---|---|---|

| | | | |

No judgment in this section. Everyone has unhealthy coping mechanisms. The ones who deny it are the most dangerous to themselves. Write it down.

5C. Personal Resilience Toolkit

List the specific tools, practices, and resources that help you recover and stay mentally grounded.

For each tool:

- **Name it**
- **When you use it** (daily, when triggered, after hard weeks, etc.)
- **Why it works for you**

Minimum of 5 tools. Include at least one physical, one mental/cognitive, one relational, and one spiritual or meaning-based (whatever that means for you).

5D. Support Network Map

Map your support network. Be honest about what's actually there, not what you wish were there.

Inner Circle (people you can call at 2am — no judgment, full trust):

- Names and relationship:

Close Support (people who check in regularly, you can lean on):

- Names and relationship:

Professional Support (therapist, counselor, coach, chaplain, psychiatrist):

- Names, type, and frequency:

Community (group, organization, faith community, unit alumni network):

- Names and how often you engage:

Gaps — who or what needs to be added to your support network:

What is specifically stopping you from closing those gaps, and what is your plan?

5E. Mental Health Commitment

Write one specific, actionable commitment to your mental health this month. Not a vague intention. A commitment with a date, a method, and a way to measure follow-through.

Example: "This month I will schedule and attend my first appointment with a VA mental health counselor. I will call the VA clinic by Friday, May 16, and have an appointment on the books by May 23. I will track this in my habit tracker and tell my accountability partner I've committed to it."

REFLECTION: THE FULL PICTURE

After completing all five parts, answer the following questions. Minimum one paragraph each.

1. What surprised you most about completing this Blueprint?
2. Which section was the hardest to fill out honestly? Why?
3. Looking at your Identity Map and your Career/Financial plan side by side — do they align? Are you building toward a life that matches who you say you are? Where are the gaps?
4. What is the single most important action you need to take in the next 7 days as a result of completing this document?
5. What does your best civilian self look like in 12 months — specifically?

GRADING CRITERIA

This project is worth **100 points** toward your course grade.

Category	Points	What We're Looking For
Completeness	20	All five parts fully answered, no skipped sections, reflection completed
Specificity	25	Concrete names, numbers, dates, and actions — not vague intentions
Honest Self-Assessment	20	Evidence of genuine reflection, including uncomfortable truths
Alignment	15	Parts 1-5 connect logically — your identity, structure, finances, career, and resilience point in the same direction
Actionability	15	Plans are realistic and executable, not aspirational fluff
Presentation	5	Clean, organized, labeled, readable

Grading Note: You will not be graded on whether your situation is good. You will be graded on whether you looked at it clearly and built something real. A student with \$40,000 in debt and a clear plan scores higher than a student with \$0 in debt and vague intentions.

SUBMISSION FORMAT

- **File type:** PDF or Google Doc link (must be set to "anyone with link can comment")
 - **File name:** LastName_FirstName_CivilianRebuildBlueprint.pdf
 - **Submission location:** Course portal → Module 5 → Mid-Course Project Submission
 - **Deadline:** As posted in the course schedule. No late submissions accepted without a pre-approved extension.
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A NOTE BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

Read your completed Blueprint from top to bottom before you hit submit.

Does it sound like you? Does it reflect what's actually going on in your life, or does it reflect what you want someone to think about your life?

The point of this document is not to impress anyone. It is to force clarity. The military trained you to execute under uncertainty — but clarity reduces that uncertainty. This is your mission brief. Make it accurate.

MISSION REBUILD™ | Mid-Course Project | Version 1.0

Modules 1-5 Integration | The Civilian Rebuild Blueprint